

Project XTC

Working Paper 009

Chapter 9 – Motor Faders: More Than Moving Sliders

Motor faders are the feature that separates the X-Touch from most inexpensive MIDI controllers. They don't merely send values to Bitwig—they also receive them. This two-way communication is what makes the controller feel alive.

The Computer Is in Charge

A common misconception is that the X-Touch 'stores' the current fader positions. It doesn't. Bitwig continuously tells the controller where every fader should be. When you open a project, change banks or play back automation, the motors move to reflect the software's current state.

Touch Sensitivity

Each channel fader detects when your finger is resting on it. DrivenByMoss uses this information to decide when you intend to take manual control during automation recording. Touching a fader is therefore different from simply watching it move.

Why?

Think of a motor fader as a shared steering wheel. Most of the time Bitwig is driving. The moment you place a finger on the fader, you're politely asking to take over. When you let go, Bitwig resumes control.

Good Habits

- Let the motor finish moving before grabbing the fader.
- Avoid forcing a moving fader against the motor.
- Watch the fader during automation playback—it becomes a visual representation of your mix.

Field Note #002

If your motor faders suddenly stop moving, don't assume the hardware has failed. First check that the correct X-Touch INT MIDI ports are still selected in DrivenByMoss and that the controller remains in MCU mode. In most cases, communication—not mechanics—is the real culprit.

Exercise

Create simple volume automation on one track. Play the project and observe the motor following every movement. Now touch the fader during playback and feel how the hardware and software cooperate instead of competing.